

Interference tactics: White, move 26

Interference tactics

White to move

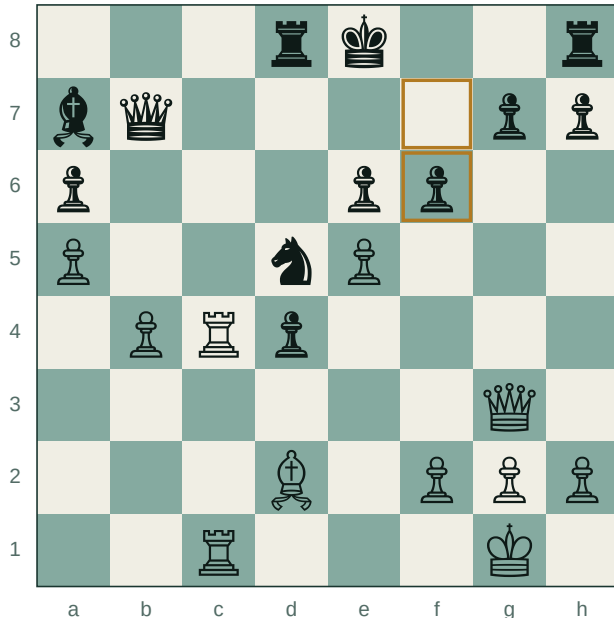
WHAT THIS POSITION TEACHES

Interference interrupts a defensive line between enemy pieces. Occupying one square can make a previously protected target vulnerable or prevent an important recapture.

HOW TO LOOK

Trace the defender's line to its target and inspect forcing moves onto the intervening squares.

The defending king is on e8. Geometrically undefended: rook on h8 and queen on b7. Check for tactical protection.



Previous move: 25...f6. Gold borders mark its start and finish.

WORKED CONTINUATION - COVER THIS SECTION FIRST

26. Rc7 Nxc7 27. Qxg7 Rf8 28. Rxc7 Qxc7 29. Qxc7

26.Rc7 The rook moves from c4 to c7. Recorded reply: **26...Nxc7**.

27.Qxg7 The queen captures the pawn on g7. From g7 it attacks rook on h8 and knight on c7. Recorded reply: **27...Rf8**.

28.Rxc7 The rook captures the knight on c7. Recorded reply: **28...Qxc7**.

29.Qxc7 The queen captures the queen on c7. From c7 it attacks rook on d8 and bishop on a7.

At the end, nominal material is White 18 / Black 18 (P=1, N/B=3, R=5, Q=9). Over this line, White's balance changes by +3. Activity and king safety still affect the evaluation.

CHECKPOINT

Using P=1, N/B=3, R=5, Q=9, how much does White's material balance change over the complete line? **Answer: +3:** the balance goes from -3 to +0. Count promotions and every recapture, not just the first gain.

CARRY THE IDEA INTO YOUR GAMES

Capturing the interposing piece may restore defense. Calculate which captures are legal and whether they permit another tactic.